



DELHI | The Raj Calculus

Heavy political tonnage came into play for the latest gubernatorial appointments. Of the five new governors, the most high-profile one was the transfer of National Security Adviser M.K. Narayanan to Raj Bhavan in West Bengal, a state slated to go to the polls next year. Now this is being interpreted as more of an ouster than a routine move, particularly after Home Minister P. Chidambaram's talk of a unified structure for internal security that could infringe on the current powers of the NSA. Tipped to take over Narayanan's job is former foreign secretary Shiv Shankar Menon, leading to speculation that the NSA could now be limited to foreign policy. Shivraj Patil's rehabilitation was expected after he resigned as home minister post-26/11. A Sonia Gandhi favourite and a stickler for the rule book, the joke is that he suits the role of governor, down to his well-tailored *bundgalas*. Another interesting appointment is ex-defence secretary Shekhar Dutt, the Chhattisgarh governor whose brother-in-law Pulok Chatterji is close to 10 Janpath. MOH Farook, a Congressman and former ambassador to Saudi Arabia will need diplomatic skills in his new posting to volatile Jharkhand. Congress leader Urmila Singh is now in Himachal Pradesh. Despite the UPA being propped up by regional parties, the Congress again walks away with all Raj Bhavan plums. **by Priya Sahgal**

**NARAYANAN'S
APPOINTMENT
WAS THE
MOST HIGH-
PROFILE ONE**

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**new governors
have been
appointed by
the UPA
Government
while three
senior
Congressmen
have been
transferred.**